

Intellectual Property Assignment Policy

All work product created during employment by an employee of the company is assigned to the company as a condition of their employment. This means that any ideas, concepts, designs, writings, or other creative works developed while on company time or using company resources are considered the property of the company and will be subject to the terms of this policy. As described under the Employee Social Media Conduct Guidelines, employees should not share confidential or proprietary information about their work on social media platforms, as this could potentially compromise the company's intellectual property rights.

Employees who have pre-existing personal inventions that they wish to bring into the workplace are required to disclose them in writing at the time of hire. This disclosure must be made in a signed and dated document, which will be retained by the company for its records. The Disclosure Form for Pre-Existing Inventions (available on the company's intranet) provides guidance on what constitutes a pre-existing invention and how to properly disclose it. As stated under the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Commitment Policy, the company values diversity of thought and experience, including the contributions of employees with unique perspectives and backgrounds.

The company recognizes that intellectual property is a valuable asset and will take all necessary steps to protect its rights. Employees are expected to respect the company's intellectual property rights and not use or disclose confidential information without authorization. As described under the Confidential Information Policy, employees must keep confidential any information that is shared with them in confidence, including trade secrets, business strategies, and other proprietary information. By working together, we can ensure that our collective creativity and innovation are protected and used to drive business success.

In the event of a dispute over intellectual property rights, the company will follow the procedures outlined under the Dispute Resolution Policy. Employees who have questions or concerns about this policy should contact their supervisor or HR representative for guidance.